

Giona Granchelli

Senior JVM & Platform Engineer /
Developer Tooling, Distributed Systems &
Agentic AI

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Hands-on JVM engineer with 10+ years designing, building, and operating distributed systems in banking, fintech, and cloud-native environments. Deep Java/Kotlin engineering across Spring Boot, Kafka, CQRS, and Kubernetes-based platforms, paired with developer tooling and governed AI-assisted engineering workflows. Currently Chapter Lead Java & VueJS at ABN AMRO: technically hands-on while leading approximately 45 engineers across 5 teams in a regulated banking environment.

Core Skills

JVM & Backend Engineering	Java, Kotlin, JVM, Spring Boot, REST APIs, microservices, gRPC, enterprise backends
Developer Tooling	IntelliJ Platform plugins, agentic coding workflows, CI/CD, developer productivity
Distributed Systems	Kafka, CQRS, event-driven architecture, Axon Framework, data pipelines
Cloud & Platform	Kubernetes, Docker, Azure AKS, AWS, cloud-native migration, deployment patterns
Reliability	Observability, incident investigation, root-cause analysis, production reliability
AI Agents	Governed agentic workflows, approval controls, auditable execution

Professional Experience

Oct 2024 - Now **Chapter Lead Java & VueJS | Software Engineer IV, ABN AMRO - BCDB, Amsterdam, Netherlands**

Copilot Champion & AI Adoption Lead. Technically hands-on JVM engineer who also operates at significant organizational scope: Chapter Lead for approximately 45 engineers across 5 teams, accountable for engineering capability, technical standards, cross-team delivery, hiring, and performance management in a regulated banking environment.

- Hands-on engineering across the department's JVM estate: reconciliation jobs, ETL pipelines, and legacy Java, Struts, and Spring Boot services, plus the developer tooling that supports them.
- Migrated 10 legacy applications (old Java, Struts, Spring Boot) using an agentic migration workflow, cutting an estimated 18+ months of effort to approximately 4 months.
- Established a shared repository of reusable agentic workflows for backend, frontend, and infrastructure teams, bringing governed AI-assisted engineering into everyday delivery.
- Built agentic workflows integrating Azure DevOps for incident investigation and management, and an end-to-end software-delivery workflow that uses requirements and work-item context to generate and refine stories, implement changes, open PRs, perform reviews, and update engineering systems.
- Built the governance framework underpinning all agentic workflows: approval controls, auditable execution, and governed workflows with human-in-the-loop review.
- Led modernization initiatives for legacy services, defining migration paths toward cloud-native architectures on Azure AKS, and designed Kubernetes-based platform patterns, CI/CD pipelines, and developer tooling to standardize containerization and deployment across teams.
- Built and improved reconciliation jobs validating financial data consistency across multiple banking systems, and improved reliability, observability, and operational robustness of batch and integration flows handling critical banking workloads.
- Acted as a technical multiplier for multiple teams by introducing reusable engineering patterns, paved-road style tooling, and migration guidance.
- Stack: Kubernetes, Azure, AKS, Azure DevOps, Java, TypeScript, Kafka, agentic AI workflows

Sep 2020 - Sep 2024	Full-stack Software Engineer IV, ABN AMRO - Strategy and Innovation, Amsterdam, Netherlands PayDay: core engineer for a fintech platform enabling instant payouts for gig-economy workers and freelancers. - Designed and implemented Kotlin and Spring Boot backend services for payment and payout workflows in a regulated financial environment. - Contributed to architecture decisions around transaction handling, system integration, and scalable service boundaries. - Stack: Kotlin, Spring Boot, Vue.js, Android, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS S3, PostgreSQL, GitLab CI
May 2020 - Jul 2020	Software Engineer, Ximedes, Haarlem, Netherlands Project for the Dutch public transportation sector (NS): end-to-end solution enabling travel with QR codes instead of conventional tickets. - Built backend and integration components for ticketing workflows; contributed real-time features using WebSockets. - Stack: Kotlin, Ktor, REST, WebSocket, ReactJS, TypeScript, Redis
Oct 2019 - Apr 2020	Full Stack Developer, BLOX - BTC Direct, Amsterdam / Nijmegen, Netherlands Cryptocurrency trading platform serving approximately 500k daily users. - Maintained and extended microservices for trading, account management, and analytics on a distributed event-driven architecture (Axon Framework, CQRS). - Improved stability and performance across multiple backend services. - Stack: Java 8, Kotlin, Spring Boot, REST, gRPC, Axon Framework, Node.js, ReactJS, MariaDB, Docker, Kubernetes, GitLab CI
Jan 2019 - Sep 2019	Senior Software Developer, WoodWing B.V., Zaandam, Netherlands Elvis, a scalable distributed Digital Asset Management system for creating, managing, and distributing digital assets. - Implemented an SSO solution integrating third-party and internal applications (AWS Cognito, Okta) and helped split a monolith by extracting auth capabilities. - Worked with a custom CQRS-style approach built around a modified use of Elasticsearch. - Stack: Java 8, Spring Framework, Elasticsearch, AWS, Jenkins, Docker, REST, AngularJS, Node.js, Okta
Jul 2017 - Jan 2019	Full Stack Developer, Trifork B.V., Amsterdam, Netherlands Multiple projects in small agile consultancy teams, combining backend delivery, frontend work, and rapid onboarding into new domains. - Contributed to IBE, a cloud-based teacher-student exam platform used in Switzerland; migrated and rebuilt CI/CD pipelines from Jenkins to GitLab. - Stack: J2EE, Kotlin, Spring Boot, REST, gRPC, Axon Framework, Node.js, ReactJS, Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, GitLab CI
Oct 2016 - Mar 2017	Research Scholarship: Tactics (EU project), University of L'Aquila, L'Aquila, Italy European project Tactics with Thales Chieti and Finmeccanica (Leonardo): SOAP-based services over a new ZigBee military tactical network for NATO troops. Stack: J2EE, Spring Framework, Spring Boot, SOAP, REST, Hibernate, JQuery, DDS, WebDDS
Mar 2016 - Sep 2016	Research Scholarship: USRA, University of L'Aquila, L'Aquila, Italy Enterprise system for the post-earthquake rebuilding of L'Aquila with USRA (Ufficio Speciale Ricostruzione dell'Aquila): inspection, review, request, classification, and refund of real estate. Developed from scratch. Stack: J2EE, Hibernate, Spring Framework, Maven, SVN, REST, JQuery, MySQL, HTML5, CSS3

Selected Projects

IntelliAiBridge (IntelliJ Platform plugin, JetBrains Marketplace: AiBridge)	IntelliJ Platform plugin/integration enabling approved external agentic tooling to use enterprise Copilot capabilities while preserving enterprise authentication, authorization, and network/data boundaries. External agents talk to the plugin through the standard OpenAI protocol, which routes requests through the authenticated Copilot session already running inside the IDE.
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TramAI (open source, Apache-2.0, tramai.dev)	A JVM runtime for governed AI applications: portable model providers, multi-agent workflows, approval controls, and auditable execution. Designed for production systems where portability, governance, and operational visibility are requirements rather than optional extras (github.com/GionaGranchelli/tramAI).
QMD / OpenClaw	Kotlin Multiplatform/Ktor control surface for multi-model agent orchestration; QMD provides surgical local retrieval over thousands of documents.

Talks & Teaching

June 2026	Guest lecturer, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam (VU Amsterdam): industry lecture on AI-assisted and agentic software engineering.
2026	Speaker, Ktconf 2026 (Kotlin conference).

Education

Sep 2015 - Mar 2017	Master Degree in Computer Science , <i>University of L'Aquila</i> , L'Aquila (AQ), Italy, maximum score, cum laude Thesis: Architecture Recovery of Microservice-based Systems.
Dec 2013 - Jun 2014	First Level Postgraduate Master Degree in Web Technologies , <i>University of L'Aquila</i> , L'Aquila (AQ), Italy
Sep 2009 - Jul 2013	Bachelor Degree in Computer Science , <i>University of L'Aquila</i> , L'Aquila (AQ), Italy, 99/110

Publications

- [1] MicroART: A Software Architecture Recovery Tool for Maintaining Microservice-based Systems. In Proceedings of the 14th International Conference on Software Architecture (ICSA). IEEE, 2017.
- [2] Towards Recovering the Software Architecture of Microservice-based Systems. In IEEE International Workshop on Architecting with MicroServices (AMS), April 2017.